

Elliot Spears

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Research Interests

Asset Pricing; Banking; Macro-Finance; Macroeconomics; Monetary Economics

Education

University of Washington, Seattle PhD in Economics, expected Dec. 2026	Seattle, WA
University of Texas at Austin M.A. in Economics, 2022	Austin, TX
University of Colorado Boulder B.A. in Mathematics, 2019	Boulder, CO

Working Papers

Forward Guidance and the Dynamics of Bank Credit
(2025)

Forward guidance contracts bank credit through a bank capital channel: contractionary signals raise leverage and force persistent credit tightening

Government Debt and the Transmission of Monetary Policy to Credit
(2026)

The banking system's response to monetary policy shocks is state-dependent: higher government debt dampens credit contractions following monetary tightenings

Social Security and Unfunded Government Debt
(2026)

Social Security financing affects inflation and intergenerational welfare; full fiscal backing limits inflation, while benefit and tax reforms redistribute welfare across generations.

Teaching Experience

University of Washington, Seattle — Graduate Teaching Assistant 2022–Present
Intermediate Macroeconomics, Operations Management (MBA), Introduction to Macroeconomics, Introduction to Microeconomics

Employment

University of Washington, Seattle — Instructor

2022–Present

- Independently teaches undergraduate microeconomics and macroeconomics courses
- Served as sole instructor for large lecture sections with up to 180 students
- Delivers lectures twice weekly
- Presents complex quantitative concepts to diverse audiences
- Develops instructional materials and assesses performance outcomes via problem sets and examinations

Presentations

** denotes scheduled*

Southern Economic Association Annual Conference*

November 2026, Houston, TX

Royal Economic Society Annual Conference

July 2026, Newcastle, UK

T2M Conference (PhD Student Session)

June 2026, Montreal, Canada

Awards

Steven Langton Teaching Award

June 2026

Awarded to graduate student instructors who demonstrate excellence in teaching.

George and Pearl Corkery Scholarship

September 2022

Award created to support recruiting exceptional applicants to the PhD program.

Leadership and Service

University of Colorado Boulder — German Club, President

2015–2016

Led an undergraduate community supporting German language practice and cultural engagement

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, STATA, MATLAB, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Libraries: pandas, numpy, scikit-learn, statsmodels, seaborn, matplotlib, tidyverse, fixest

Modeling: DSGE, Stochastic Calculus, Time-Series Econometrics, Forecasting, Machine Learning, Causal Inference, Partial Differential Equations

Methods: OLS, 2SLS, Logit, DiD, VAR, ARIMA, Local Projections, Kalman Filtering

Certifications

Goethe-Zertifikat C1 (German), 2016

Personal Details

Citizenship: U.S.

Languages: English (native), German (fluent)